

Mikayle Despaigne

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Portfolio: <https://mikayle-desp-portfolio.framer.website/>

EDUCATION

Smith College – Northampton, MA

Expected May 2027

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

GPA: 3.67 | Honors/Awards: Posse Foundation Full-Tuition Leadership and Academic Scholarship

Relevant coursework: Object Oriented Programming, Data Structures, Discrete Math, Web Programming, Theory of Computation, Software Design and Development

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Programming Languages:** HTML, CSS, Javascript, Java, Python
- **Frameworks & Developer Tools:** React.js, Vue.js, Figma, Jira, Confluence, Visual Studio Code, Git/GitHub
- **Certifications:** Google UX Design Certificate, Coursera (2024)

EXPERIENCE

People Inc. - Frontend Software Engineering Intern | New York, NY

June 2025 – August 2025

- Refactored myrecipes.com search components using Globe (internal JS framework) and Vue, improving structure and reusability to support a more consistent and scalable user interface.
- Resolved UI bugs on allrecipes.com (4M+ daily users), enhancing usability and interface consistency.
- Worked cross-functionally in agile sprints with design, product and QA to ship updates.

Vivian Health - UX Engineering and Research Intern | Remote

June 2024 – August 2024

- Maintained 25+ reusable UI components in React.js and resolved SCSS styling bugs to improve stability and scalability.
- Led a UX research project, interviewing 16+ engineers to uncover and address Storybook documentation pain points.
- Implemented documentation improvements with React and MDX, resulting in a boost in frontend team efficiency.

IBM - UX Design Fellow | New York, NY

June 2024 – July 2024

- Completed training in UI/UX, service design, and AI ethics, and presented an ethical AI-driven course tracking redesign to IBM design staff and 13+ fellows.

America On Tech - UX Design Fellow | New York, NY

September 2023 - January 2024

- Mastered Figma to design inclusive high-fidelity prototypes, led an Instagram redesign with 2 user research rounds boosting satisfaction by 50%, and presented key UX insights to 10+ fellows.

PROJECTS

PAL - UX Designer for UCI's Design-a-thon

[View Project](#)

- Conducted market research on other elderly care platforms to identify UX/UI trends and user needs, then designed clean, user-centered prototypes using Figma.

Open Pages - UX Designer and Software Engineer

[GitHub](#)

- Designed original Figma prototypes and developed a full-stack journaling web app using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and PHP, translating the design into a responsive, functional app.

LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

Smith College Computer Science Department Liaison | Northampton, MA

June 2025 - Present

IAC Fellow | New York, NY

June 2024 – Present

ColorStack | Remote

June 2024 – Present

SEO Scholar | New York, NY

September 2016 – Present